developers to quickly select a board using a visual matrix of important features. Thirty different parameters can be selected and sorted including processor type and speed, memory and expansion capabilities, wireless and wired networking, user interface options, video connectivity, and more. Online materials include user guides, PCB files, schematics and complete documentation. Supporting software for each board is available for fast, direct download.

Under the *Hardware* section is a listing of available OSHW boards by category, including the newest Arduino and Arduino-compatible, BeagleBoard, Intel and TI LaunchPad boards. The site makes it easy to find related hardware such as BeagleBone Capes, Arduino Shields and other useful accessories. In the *Featured Products* section, developers can find the newest OSHW boards including the Intel Edison miniature computer, Texas Instruments' MSP-EXP432 LaunchPad, and the Arduino Lilypad for wearables. All hardware is available for same-day shipping from Mouser.com.

The *Articles* section contains new articles, including a discussion on open source vs proprietary hardware. Last, the *Technical Resources* section has new, related resources including updated application notes, white papers, and more to further assist developers.

Google Maps for Android offers offline search and navigation

Considering that many nations in the world are struggling with data connectivity issues, particularly when users are on-the-go, Google has launched offline search and navigation options for Google Maps for Android. The support for offline maps comes with voice-enabled turn-by-turn directions and search support, and all this can be accessed with data connectivity. This new feature will arrive in India some time later this year. So, once this feature is enabled in Google Maps for Android, you will just need to save the map of a particular area in order to navigate and enjoy a local experience, even without any data connectivity.

Another new feature that will make Google Maps for Android an interesting offering is when searching for places, users will benefit from auto-complete suggestions, reviews and opening hours.

Red Hat introduces the Red Hat Cloud Suite for Applications

Red Hat Inc., one of the world's leading providers of open source solutions, has launched the Red Hat Cloud Suite for Applications, an accelerated way to develop, deploy and manage applications at scale using open source technologies. As organisations move to the cloud, many are evolving toward micro-services architectures that run within containers to increase scalability, portability and efficiency. These new architectures require massively scalable infrastructure in order to realise their full potential. However, many organisations also have high-volume workloads that are not yet compatible with micro-services or container based architecture, but which could benefit from having a solution that supports both applications running within virtual machines and new container based application architectures. For example, developers may require storage services that are necessary for stateful application

Open Web device Compliance Review Board (CRB) certifies the first round of handsets

The open Web device Compliance Review Board (CRB) and its members, Alcatel One Touch, Deutsche Telekom, Mozilla, Qualcomm Technologies Inc. and Telefonica, have announced the first devices to be certified by CRB, which is an independent firm established to encourage the open Web device ecosystem by promoting API compliance and ensuring competitive performance. The two handsets are Alcatel ONETOUCH Fire C and Alcatel ONETOUCH Fire E.

Established in 2004, Alcatel Mobile Phones is a joint venture between Alcatel-Lucent and TCL Communication. The validation process includes OEMs applying to the CRB for their handsets to be approved. CRB's labs not only check the device for open Web APIs and key performance benchmarks, but also compare the results with the benchmarks set by the CRB.

The process is open to all device vendors including CRB members and non-members. The certification process has been published on the CRB website: *www.openwebdevice.org*

Jason Bremner, senior vice president of product management, Qualcomm Technologies, said that he was glad to know that the board has accomplished one of its major objectives in certifying Firefox OS devices on a standard set of Web APIs and performance metrics. The expectation is that other firms will improve their product development cycle time and ensure a convincing user experience with compliance to standard Web APIs.